

Words in Context, and What Words Point To

Name: _____

Class: _____

Date: _____

Write all answers in your book. Number each one.

Word in context Use the words around it to work out what it means here. Shades of meaning matter.	Reference words this, it, them, he, none of it. They point back to something already said.	Test yourself Swap the word for yours. Does the sentence still mean exactly the same? Point to the exact words the reference word replaces.
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Part A: Do Now (5 min, on your own)

Last lesson: author's craft. The writer ___ so that the reader ___.

A1 It was the last time anyone saw her alive.

Why might a writer open a chapter with this sentence?

A2 Dad said nothing. He put the car into gear and drove.

Why does the writer not tell us how Dad feels?

Part B: Nonsense Word Detective (pairs)

Four of these words are invented. You can still work out what each one means. For each: what does it mean, and which words in the sentence told you? Bonus: two of them are real English words. Which two?

1 The soup was so brimmy that I had to add cold water before I could drink it. 2 After three weeks without rain, the riverbed was completely skelthed. 3 He gave a quick nardle of his head to show that he agreed.	4 The old bridge had become so frangible that the council closed it to traffic. 5 She spoke in a voice so quillish that even the front row could not hear her. 6 The crowd turned truculent when the referee blew the final whistle.
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Part C: Drill

C1–C4: words in context.

C1 The queue crawled forward.

Which word could replace *crawled*? Why is “moved” a weaker answer?

C2 Her voice was brittle as she thanked them for coming.

What does *brittle* suggest about her here?

C3 He scrutinised the photograph for a long time.

Closest meaning: glanced at, examined closely, or ignored? Explain.

C4 The minister's answer to the question was slippery.

What does *slippery* tell you about the answer?

C5–C7: reference words. Write the exact words that each one points back to.

C5 Maya put the letter in the drawer with the others. She had never opened a single one of them.

What does “them” refer to?

C6 The council promised new bins, better lighting and more frequent buses. None of it happened.

What does “it” refer to?

C7 Ravi handed the envelope to his brother. This was the moment he had dreaded for weeks.

What does “This” refer to? Who is “he”, and how can you tell?

Part D: Exit Ticket (on your own, 2 marks)

D The storm had uprooted three trees, smashed a greenhouse and left half the village without power. Nobody had expected any of it.

(a) What does “it” refer to? (b) Give one word that could replace *uprooted*, and say what it suggests about the storm.